

Your Complete Rebranding Checklist

Everything a company needs to navigate a rebrand — from the first internal conversation to the day of launch.

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A rebrand touches more parts of an organisation than most people anticipate. Brand assets live everywhere — in sales decks and email signatures, in social media bios and product interfaces, in legal documents and vendor contracts. Getting the rebrand right requires a systematic approach. This checklist covers every phase of the process, from internal alignment through to launch day.

Phase 1 — Define the strategic need

Before any creative work begins, the organisation needs to agree on why the rebrand is happening and what success looks like.

- ☐ Document the specific reason for rebranding (pivot, acquisition, trust problem, new market entry, dated identity)
- ☐ Align executive stakeholders on the scope before briefing any agency
- ☐ Define what must be preserved (equity, recognisable assets, trusted associations)
- ☐ Define what must change (and be honest about the difference between "we want something fresh" and "this is genuinely broken")
- ☐ Set a clear success definition — how will you know the rebrand worked?
- ☐ Assign a single internal owner with decision-making authority

Phase 2 — Select your agency partner

The agency selection process is often rushed. Allocating proper time here is one of the highest-return investments in the entire rebrand.

- ☐ Shortlist agencies whose existing work demonstrates the quality you want
- ☐ Review case studies in your category or adjacent categories
- ☐ Ask for evidence of the agency's strategic process, not just visual outputs
- ☐ Conduct briefed presentations (not speculative creative) from 2–3 shortlisted agencies
- ☐ Meet the specific team members who will work on your project
- ☐ Clarify ownership of intellectual property in the contract

Phase 3 — Brand strategy and positioning

All subsequent creative work flows from a clear brand strategy. This phase should not be rushed.

- ☐ Complete a brand audit of all current brand assets and touchpoints
- ☐ Conduct competitive analysis — visual and verbal landscape of your category
- ☐ Run stakeholder interviews (founders, senior leaders, sales, customer support)
- ☐ Define or refine target audience personas
- ☐ Develop and validate the brand positioning statement
- ☐ Create the messaging hierarchy (core promise !' proof points !' audience-specific adaptations)

- ☐ Develop tone of voice principles with before/after copy examples
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| Phase 4 — Identity design

The creative phase, working within the strategic framework developed in Phase 3.

- ☐ Brief visual exploration from the strategy — not open-ended creative
 - ☐ Evaluate visual directions against strategic criteria, not personal preference
 - ☐ Develop chosen direction into a complete identity system
 - ☐ Test identity across key applications before finalising (business cards, website hero, app icon, social avatar)
 - ☐ Ensure accessibility compliance (contrast ratios, colour-blindness considerations)
 - ☐ Complete comprehensive brand guidelines before launch
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| Phase 5 — Asset production and rollout planning

The work that happens between brand approval and launch day.

- ☐ Audit every existing touchpoint where brand assets appear
 - ☐ Prioritise touchpoints by audience impact and update urgency
 - ☐ Create a rollout schedule with owners and deadlines for every touchpoint
 - ☐ Brief all internal teams (marketing, sales, product, support) before launch
 - ☐ Prepare updated templates (email signatures, sales decks, social profiles)
 - ☐ Update digital properties (website, app stores, social media)
 - ☐ Update legal and compliance documents
 - ☐ Update vendor and partner communications
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| Phase 6 — Internal launch

Internal launch before external launch is not optional. Employees who are surprised by a rebrand become poor ambassadors for it.

- ☐ Brief all employees on the strategy behind the rebrand before it goes public
 - ☐ Provide access to all brand guidelines and updated asset templates
 - ☐ Give sales teams the updated materials they need immediately
 - ☐ Run Q&A sessions for employees who will field questions from customers
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| Phase 7 — External launch

The public moment, planned and executed with the same rigour as the brand itself.

- ☐ Coordinate website, social, and PR launch simultaneously
 - ☐ Notify key customers and partners before the public announcement where appropriate
 - ☐ Prepare answers to anticipated press and customer questions
 - ☐ Monitor brand mentions and respond to significant coverage in the brand's new voice
 - ☐ Document any remaining touchpoints missed in the rollout and assign a completion timeline
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